



UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/12

Paper 1 Reading Passage (Core)

May/June 2013

READING BOOKLET INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with all questions on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Insert and use the blank spaces for planning. This Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Read the following passage carefully and then answer all the questions on the Question Paper.

In this passage the writer, Kevin Pilley, describes his experience of visiting an underwater hotel off the coast of Florida.

Barracuda Breakfast

In the Emerald Lagoon in Key Largo, 86 kilometres south of Miami, is the world's first and only underwater hotel.

Everything in Florida involves large volumes of water. The southern-most state of the USA is the self-proclaimed water sports capital of the world and now, after all that snorkelling, water skiing, swimming with dolphins, hand-feeding moray eels, plus all those jetties, jacuzzis and glass-bottomed boat rides, you can even sleep the night surrounded by water if you want to.

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Opened in 1986, the Jules Verne Lodge, sunk 9 metres down in the Undersea Park close to the Key Largo Marine Sanctuary, can accommodate up to six in bunk-style accommodation in two bedrooms. Inside your 3 metres by 15 metres undersea sub-Atlantic habitat, formerly a marine research laboratory, you feel odd. It is as if you have veered off the road in your large hi-tech caravan and plunged into the sea only to land, right way up, on the sandy bottom. The Jules Verne underwater-suite is more of a submerged caravan than a hotel. But it is exclusive. Nobody bothers you for matches or sugar and the only spies are fish such as barracudas.

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Each large, circular window offers a sea view. The American owners are keen to offer you 'limitless opportunities' and 'the ultimate' – waking in the morning and drawing the curtain to see a metre-long barracuda staring at you is surely some kind of ultimate. Few Europeans get the chance to observe marine life so closely. Likewise the colourful marine life make the most of the limitless opportunities of observing at close-range, tourists in their colourful designer pyjamas.

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When you check-in you need not show your passport, only a diving certificate. If you haven't dived before you can attend a three-hour 'aquatic habitat orientation programme' which involves learning what salt water tastes like and how to put flippers on the right way. The secret of putting flippers on is that there is no secret. There is no right or wrong way to put on flippers. There is no such thing as a left or right flipper. If you remember flippers go on your feet, you can't go far wrong.

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The programme is taken by the world's only full-time professional mermaid, Carla Rush, a 40-year-old from Illinois and former captain of a local dive charter boat. She has been a 'pro' mermaid for nearly two years and will teach you how to operate your flippers, the rudiments of breathing compressed air, help you in and out of your wetsuit, clean your mask for you, bring your meals, wash up, carry your bags and do anything else that needs doing, including pushing you in.

25

After a short downward swim you emerge up from under the hotel into a dive port from where, once Carla has eased you out of your oxygen tank, you are shown to your living chambers. These are equipped with all mod cons. Carla then leaves you to your microwave steak and lobster and returns to dry land to work the controls and answer every request of the guests. Room service is excellent and if you leave your shoes outside they are clean in the morning.

30

There isn't much to do under water but you can watch videos with John Wayne and, predictably, *Splash* and *20,000 Leagues Under The Sea*. You can hope that somebody rings you up. Wrong numbers are fun. You can ring anybody in the world or you can merely wonder how much air you have in your 55 square metres of living space. The brochure boasts 'limitless' air supply as part of your package.

40

If lucky you might get a sighting of a manatee swimming past your dining room window. A manatee is a curious looking and very rare marine creature which can only be described as having a bald man's head and the body of a stout middle-aged woman, weighing 136 kilograms.

When you check out you decompress. This ensures that you aren't suffering from 'the bends', a sickness caused by decompression, and receive your treasured Aquanaut certificate which verifies that you have spent the whole night in the sea and enjoyed all the benefits of the experience. These are obvious. Staying underwater in Florida is the best way to avoid sunburn, mosquitoes and annoying tourist activities!

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CANDIDATE
NAME

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CENTRE
NUMBER

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CANDIDATE
NUMBER

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FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/12

Paper 1 Reading Passage (Core)

May/June 2013

1 hour 45 minutes

Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name in the spaces provided.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do **not** use staples, paper clips, glue or correction fluid.

DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Answer **all** questions in the space provided. If additional space is required, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet. The question number(s) must be clearly shown.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **all** questions on this Question Paper. The Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **9** printed pages, **3** blank pages and **1** Reading Booklet Insert.

Read carefully the passage *Barracuda Breakfast* in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer all the questions on this Question Paper.

For
Examiner's
Use

Question 1

- (a) What is the name of the underwater hotel described in the passage?

• [1]

- (b) From paragraphs three and four (Opened in...designer pyjamas.), explain, **using your own words**, what the rooms are like in the underwater hotel.

.....
.....
.....
..... [2]

- (c) What effect does the writer achieve by using the short sentence 'But it is exclusive.' (line 12)?

.....
.....
.....
..... [2]

- (d) Explain fully, **using your own words**:

- (i) what happens in the 'aquatic habit orientation programme' described in paragraphs five and six (When you check-in...pushing you in).

.....
.....
.....
..... [2]

- (ii) how the writer's description of the programme suggests that he is being sarcastic about it.

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.....
.....
..... [2]

- (e) From paragraph seven (After a short...) explain, **using your own words**, how guests reach and enter the hotel.

For
Examiner's
Use

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..... [2]

- (f) Explain, **using your own words**, what the writer means by the words in italics in the following phrases:

- (i) '*self-proclaimed* water sports *capital* of the world' (line 4)

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) '*veered* off the road in your large *hi-tech* caravan' (lines 10–11)

.....

..... [2]

- (iii) '*limitless opportunities*' (line 15)

.....

..... [2]

[Turn over for Question 1(g)]

(g) Re-read paragraphs three to five (Opened in...go far wrong.).

For
Examiner's
Use

The writer uses the following phrases to make fun of what he finds on his visit to the underwater hotel.

Choose **three** of the following phrases and then explain how each one of them helps you to understand what amuses him:

- *'more of a submerged caravan than a hotel'* (line 12)
- *'only spies are fish such as barracudas'* (line 13)
- *'colourful marine life...observing at close-range, tourists in their colourful designer pyjamas'* (lines 17–18)
- *'secret of putting flippers on is that there is no secret'* (lines 21–22)

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....[2]

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....[2]

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....[2]

- Write a summary of what happens when you stay at the underwater hotel from when you check-in until you leave.

[7]

..[7]

[Total: 30]

[Turn over for Question 2]

Imagine that you have just spent a night at the hotel described in the passage.

- describe your experience
- explain what your friend would **and** would not like about a visit there.

You should base your ideas on what you have read in the passage, but do not copy from it. Address each of the two bullet points.

Write between 1 and 1½ sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

[illegible]

Additional Page

If you use the following lined page to complete the answer(s) to any question(s), the question number(s) must be clearly shown.

For
Examiner's
Use

Additional Page

For
Examiner's
Use

If you use the following lined page to complete the answer(s) to any question(s), the question number(s) must be clearly shown.

This image shows a full page of white paper designed for handwriting practice. It features 20 evenly spaced horizontal dotted lines running from left to right across the entire width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.